

MOVIE

The Batman

★★★★☆ | The Dark Knight of Gotham has taken on many characters over the years, from goofy to suave to campy to foreboding. Matt Reeves' *The Batman* portrays the titular character in yet another manner – emo. “Vengeance” as the Batman himself and his flame Selina Kyle calls him, is broody through the course of the movie. Yet it doesn't quite feel out of place due to the tonality of the script and cinematography in Reeves' rendition of the film. Robert Pattinson excels in this role with his foreboding persona. Some dialogues are slightly cringeworthy, but not so much that they pull you out of the plot.

Coming to the plot itself, the primary antagonist this time around is the Riddler, and Paul Dano does a fantastic job depicting the Riddler as a sociopath who's out to get “vengeance” against



the corrupt bureaucracy of Gotham. It's a much darker and grittier Riddler than we're accustomed to, who usually comes across as more of a B-grade villain who's around for laughs. This Riddler is meant to be taken seriously, or people will die. There are a lot of comparisons drawn

between the Riddler and the Batman, including each of their origin stories. Thankfully, the movie doesn't delve too deeply into the origins of Batman, we've had enough of those.

Zoe Kravitz is a great fit for Catwoman, however both Robert Pattinson and Paul Dano overshadow her with their respective performances. She does have her moments though.

The cinematography, especially during the action scenes, is fantastic. The way Matt Reeves uses lighting and special effects for these scenes is brilliant. However, the joke that you may need night vision goggles to watch the movie does still apply. Coming to the background score, it isn't Hans Zimmer, but it's good enough. The score does a good job of setting the scene, while being subtle.

Overall, we quite enjoyed *The Batman*. The pacing did get a bit slow at times – slow enough for us to actually fall asleep for a few seconds! – but when it picks up, you don't want to miss a moment. We'd say this was a successful Batman reboot.

–Dhriti Datta

TV SHOW

Star Trek: Prodigy

★★★★☆ | The Star Trek franchise is one that has spanned over five decades, and it's natural to be intimidated by something with the name “Star Trek” before it. A show which requires you to do homework before you can actually start enjoying it is not something everyone can stomach. Fortunately, *Star Trek Prodigy* does not fall in this boat. The animated series is a great entry point into the Star Trek universe, presenting Star Trek in a completely new way. Many new Trekkies will be born after watching *Prodigy*.

Star Trek Prodigy is an unusual spin-off. It doesn't rely on the main series in any way or form. Throughout the first season, right up until the very end of the last episode, there's no mention



of the happenings in the previous Star Trek series. We say right up until the end because it looks like in Season 2 we'll see *Prodigy* tie in with the main series.

Prodigy features a rag-tag crew of aliens who come together after escaping a mining asteroid. They do so aboard the USS Protostar. The aliens then assume the role of rookie Starfleet recruits aboard

the vessel, hoping to fool the ship's AI assistant hologram. The AI plays along, and in doing so teaches them how to function as a crew and play to their individual strengths. We're refraining from naming the AI for spoiler reasons. Also, the identity of the hologram in *Prodigy* is the only indicator in the show for what timeline in the Star Trek universe they're in. Each member of the crew gets time to shine. Also, more than half of the crew is kids or teens; we forgot to point out that the show is targeted at a much younger audience than the usual Star Trek crowd. However, that does not in any way take away from the enjoyment that can be derived from the show.

The distance from the main Star Trek series does make *Prodigy* more approachable than most Star Trek shows, but starting season two we'll definitely see the show get closer to federation space, which isn't a bad thing; we see it as a great segway into the mainstream Star Trek universe for newcomers to the franchise.

–Manish Rajesh